Good data, fair AI

AI · Level 1 · Lesson 3



Today we will

- Explain that a machine that learns from examples can make more mistakes when some examples are missing.
- Spot who or what is missing from a set of examples.
- Suggest a fair way to fill a data gap, such as adding examples from the people left out.

Remember

- AI is only as good as its examples. When some people are missing or rare, it often makes more mistakes for them.
- This is called bias. It often comes from data gaps, not from anyone meaning harm — and it happens in real tools.
- Fix gaps: collect examples from the people who will use the tool, test with different groups, let people report mistakes, keep humans checking.

Whose examples?: Test it

1. Warm-up (5 min): Ask: has a phone or app ever got someone's name or words wrong?
2. Draw examples (8 min): Each pupil draws one fruit on scrap paper and names it.
3. Test it (10 min): The class is the recogniser and may only answer with a fruit in the box.
4. Pair talk (10 min): Pairs discuss: what was missing, and how could we fix it?
5. Wrap-up (7 min): Add drawings of the missing fruit and test again.

Draw a big box on the board labelled "Our examples". Bring two or three local fruits pupils may not think to draw, such as guava, dates, prickly pear, jackfruit or a baobab pod.

Let’s discuss

1. Which drawing on the board is closest to the new fruit?
2. Is that the right answer?
3. So how could we make our examples fairer?

Exit ticket

- One thing missing from our examples, and one way to fix it.